

POLITICS ASIDE, KUMARASWAMY IS ALL SET TO PRODUCE FILMS



KUMARASWAMY

B K RAMESH

BANGALORE | Reel Love

Try as he may but former Karnataka chief minister H.D. Kumaraswamy can't distance himself from his first love—producing films. His next dream project is not ruling the state again but a period film in five languages, including English, based on Kannada novel *Hejje*. Kumaraswamy's dream cast? Aamir Khan and Kamal Hasan. The novel traces the impact of the freedom movement on an orthodox Brahmin family. Kumaraswamy also plans to produce about 10 to 15 films for Kasturi TV channel owned by his wife, Anitha. "Once a film producer, always a film producer," says a close aide of Kumaraswamy, who is all set to contest from Bangalore Rural Lok Sabha constituency. **by Stephen David**

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in per cent, is the fall in the sale of PC units between October and December last year, says MAIT.

BANGALORE | Charlie's Devils

Charpin was buried under heaps of concrete to prevent robbers from getting at his body. And there he would rather remain, considering what is happening over his name—or rather his statue—in Karnataka. Hindutva and pro-BJP activists opposed the construction of a Chaplin statue in Udupi because he was a Christian. The statue was to be installed opposite a temple. The installation was a part of a film and just as that furore died down, Jnanpith award-winner U.R. Ananthamurthy stepped in, saying Chaplin was actually a Jew. Net result: a spurt in the sales of Chaplin's biography and the DVDs of his films. Oh well. **by Nirmala Ravindran**



BHASKAR PAUL

THE 'SOFTWARE' SCHOOL BUS

MUMBAI | Route Cause

The journey from school to home has rarely been this well charted. Mumbai's JB Petit School has adopted a software-based model school bus system that works out the shortest route to a child's home. The idea is to avoid students going home by cars and thus reduce environmental pollution. The system, also implemented by the neighbouring Cathedral School earlier, had been designed by the former DCP (traffic) Himanshu Roy, and civic activist Indrani Malkani. "The system helped decongest the Fort area as it kept over 716 cars off the roads on every school day. We want to replicate the successful model in other schools in the vicinity as well," says Malkani. She adds that the state Government has taken a cue from the model and is now working on turning this system into a policy to ensure all children travel to school by bus. **by Aditi Pal**

Computer Crash

Global recession, or rather its domestic Indian variant, has claimed yet another victim. While our computers are still functioning efficiently, their sales seem to be crashing. According to the Manufacturers' Association for Information and Technology's (MAIT) Quarterly Industry Performance Review for October-December of fiscal 2008-09, PC sales in India totalled 14 lakh units (10 lakh desktops and 3.5 lakh notebooks), a de-

DEEPAK G PAWAR



WORKERS IN A COMPUTER MANUFACTURING UNIT

cline of 19 per cent over the same period last year, among the sharpest falls in the history of the industry. The desktop segment witnessed a fall in consumption by 15 per cent, and notebooks by 30 per cent over the same period last fiscal. Moreover, given the current recession, overall PC sales for 2008-09 are expected to remain at the same low levels as in the last fiscal, at 73 lakh units. These modest numbers are the result of restrained buying by the sector's glum, liquidity crunched major consumers i.e. small and medium enterprises, retail, BPO and IT-enabled services. **by Nandini Vaish**